CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Read: 'The Seth was holidaying in Kashmir. Oh, was that so? The elderly gentleman did not believe it.' The writer's attitude to the customer is: 1

(a) gently mocking **(b)** bitter **(c)** admiring **(d)** neutral

2. Extract: 'Think, Liesel... That's it, she decided, but I have to make it real.' The italics in the text indicate: 1

(a) Papa's spoken words **(b)** the narrator's date
(c) a foreign word **(d)** Liesel's inner thoughts

3. In 'Found light / Brighter than many ever see', which reading best fits the poet's purpose? 1

(a) inner insight can outshine physical sight
(b) Keller preferred darkness
(c) light is brightest at noon
(d) few people like light

4. Read: 'A slight gleam of satisfaction appeared momentarily in the face of the pale man.' The word 'momentarily' suggests that the visitor: 1

(a) was always cheerful **(b)** was bored
(c) was in a hurry **(d)** briefly let his true feeling show

5. The sentence 'A few stones were thrown, and the manager retreated indoors' uses the passive voice mainly to: 1

(a) focus on the action rather than the unnamed throwers
(b) show politeness
(c) slow the story
(d) show the manager's courage

6. 'Papa was strict' (para 40) when he said 'Nothing' because: 1

(a) he was angry at Max **(b)** firmness was needed to stop the panic
(c) he enjoyed commanding **(d)** he disliked Rosa

7. The enjambment 'And now the world receives / From her dower' is used to: 1

(a) carry the sentence smoothly across lines **(b)** start a new stanza
(c) end the poem **(d)** add a rhyme

8. The author describes the Bacteriologist as 'hatless, and in his slippers'. This most clearly shows: 1

(a) his fitness
(b) his panic and his absent-minded character
(c) his dislike of hats
(d) his wealth

9. Choose the sentence in which 'bank' means something different from its meaning in the story: 1

(a) The bank closed at four.
(b) We walked along the river bank.
(c) He opened an account in the bank.
(d) The bank manager was helpless.

10. 'Huddled' and 'crouched' are: 1

(a) close in meaning, both describing a bent, drawn-up posture
(b) unrelated
(c) homophones
(d) opposites

11. 'Wonder and admiration' in the summary shows the poet's response is: 1

(a) critical
(b) detached
(c) puzzled
(d) emotional and respectful

12. The phrase 'carefully jostling his infected body against as many people as possible' is ironic because: 1

(a) crowds are quiet
(b) the bridge was empty
(c) the man is ill
(d) the body is harmless and the 'infection' is imaginary

13. In the extract, 'The elderly gentleman did not believe it' shows that he: 1

(a) trusted the telephone
(b) investigated carefully
(c) preferred his suspicion to the plain fact
(d) doubted the rumour

14. Extract: 'Panic generated in that awful way. Throat and mouth. Air became sand.' 'Air became sand' is a: 1

(a) simile
(b) pun
(c) metaphor for difficulty in breathing
(d) hyperbole about sand dunes

15. The expression 'She, / In the dark' contains an irony, because: 1

(a) she is afraid of the dark
(b) the poet is blind
(c) the one in the dark finds more light than those who see
(d) light is found in dark rooms

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. How does the repeated phrase 'the news spread' help the structure of the story? 2

17. Explain how the first paragraph's mix of 'good news' and 'unsettling news' sets the tone. 2

18. Explain the paradox in 'She, / In the dark, / Found light'. 2

19. How does the setting of the lab add to the tension in the opening scene? 2

20. How does the writer show the contrast between rumour and fact? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Examine how the author uses repetition and escalation in the dialogue of paragraphs 6 to 16. 3

22. Analyse the use of contrast between the ordinary and the dangerous in the extract. 3

23. Critically examine the idea of 'light' in the poem: is it a gift or an achievement? 3

24. Analyse how the writer uses dialogue to reveal the Anarchist's real purpose before the reader knows it. 3

OR

Analyse the role of language such as 'bird has flown' and 'forest fire' in the story. 3

25. How do the glossary words 'perplexed', 'collided', and 'grimacing' add to the scene? 3

OR

Discuss the contrast between 'many' and 'she' and what it implies about perception. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Read: 'The news spread through the bazaar with the rapidity of a forest fire. From the general store it travelled to the tea-shop, circulated amongst the customers, and then spread with them in various directions.' 5

(a) What figure of speech is used?
(b) Why is it effective?
(c) What is the effect of the list that follows?
(d) Meaning of 'circulated'.
(e) What does it say about the town?

OR

Critically appreciate the extract 'The Visitor' as a piece of suspenseful narrative. 5

27. Write a critical appreciation of 'Helen Keller' covering theme, imagery, form, tone and message. 5

OR

'The Stolen Bacillus' is a satire on fear and fanaticism.' Discuss. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

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